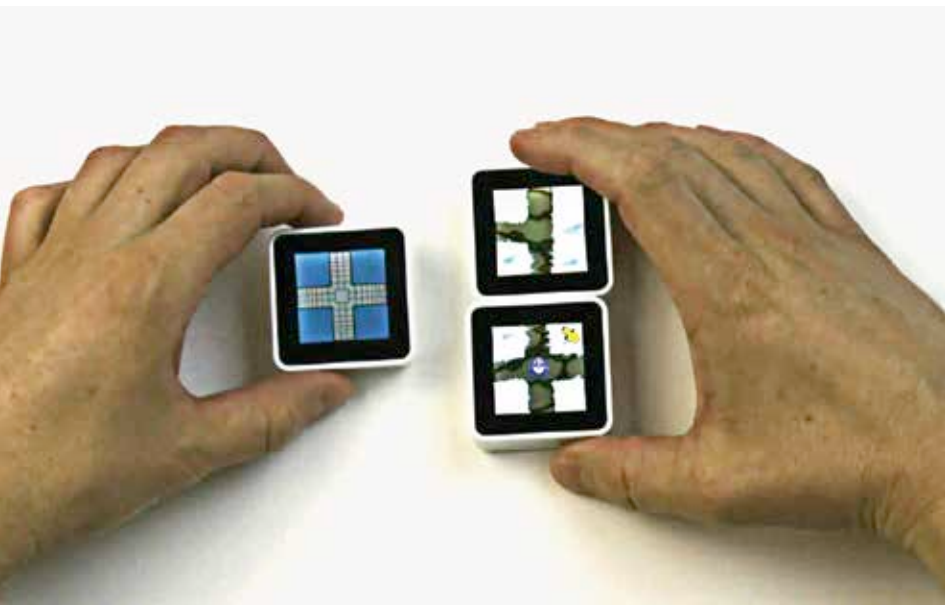




Siftables in action. Example of a game played using three siftables.

There are not too many examples of commercially viable SNUI implementations, but one does deserve a special mention for its sheer innovation and practicality: Siftables. As described by its inventors David Merrill and Jeevan Kalanithi, “Siftables aims to enable people to interact with information and media in physical, natural ways that approach interactions with physical objects in our everyday lives.” Siftables are small electronic devices with a display, and they are programmed in such a way as to intuitively and wirelessly interact with other siftables to allow for a more dynamic and natural computing experience.

For example, when one siftable is placed next to another, the parts of the display that are in proximity can light up, or change depending on a context. Think of siftables that display portraits of different people. Now imagine these portraits dynamically turning to face one another as they are placed close together. It makes for an almost human-like interaction. Other potential uses for siftables include puzzles and interactive learning toys. SNUI-based systems like siftables are still in a type of prototype stage, but they can be designed in such a way so as to take advantage of intuitive human interactions for making computing easy and fun.